

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, July 13, 2022, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward II Councilor James Contois
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Lucas Beliveau
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

John Bohenko, Interim City Manager
Lisa Richmond, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES
None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assist Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the June 22nd, 2022, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Proclamation – Roger Rumrill Retirement

Mayor Girard read a proclamation for Roger Rumrill's retirement from the Department of Public Works. Mr. Rumrill thanked the Council, his family and his wife for the support.

Mayor Girard stated there were many people in attendance tonight, and if they are here to speak on the Transfer Station; the Mayor asked to sign their name onto a sign-up sheet that was created.

Mayor Girard noted this was Interim City Manager John Bohenko's first Council meeting.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. Bohenko noted working with the City staff has been very helpful. Mr. Bohenko offered to be available anytime for the City Council.

Mr. Bohenko recognized the Recreation staff for the July 4th, there was excellent feedback from the public, and about \$1500.00 in donations were collected that will be used towards the fireworks next year.

Mr. Bohenko stated the Finance Department will review the FY2021 audit at the next Council meeting on July 27th.

Mr. Bohenko noted the interview process for the Parks and Recreation Director position has started.

Mr. Bohenko announced the switch over for our software system will effect the ability of service on the 28th and 29th of July, a press release will be sent out for this disruption.

Mr. Bohenko noted there was a resignation in our assessing department to taking a position in another City.

Mr. Bohenko concluded his report by acknowledging our Department of Public Works mechanics on their invention to fill hoppers using a conveyor and other machinery, Claremont won first place at state level and is now being submitted to a national competition.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Claremont Community Television, INC. Board of Directors.

Mayor Girard stated there were two applicants for Seat 3 of the Claremont Community Television, INC. Board of Directors; Raymond Gagnon and Kevin Tyson. Mayor Girard asked for a roll call vote by the councilors stating which applicant they want to appoint.

Roll call vote:

Contois - Gagnon

O'Hearne - Gagnon

Stone - Tyson

Matteau - Gagnon

Koloski - Tyson

Limoges - Tyson

Beliveau - Tyson

Mooshian - Gagnon

Girard - Tyson

Motion carried: 5-4 in favor of Kevin Tyson.

Personnel Advisory Board

Mayor Girard asked Council if all were in favor of Kim Halsey to be appointed to Seat 3 of the Personnel Advisory Board.

Voice vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Airport Advisory Board

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteu to re-appoint Stephen Keen to Seat 4 of the Airport Advisory Board.

Voice vote:

Contois - yes
O'Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

Airport Advisory Board

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to re-appoint Paul Dube to Seat 3 of the Airport Advisory Board.

Voice vote:
Contois - yes
O'Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Hope Damon, resident of Croydon and is running for State Representative.
Ms. Damon noted living in Croydon for thirty-seven years, and has 2 daughters.
Ms. Damon stated being a registered dietician was very rewarding and helped many people.
Ms. Damon noted always being interested in government and is at a point in their career to have the ability to invest time and effort into being a State Representative. Ms. Damon is a breast cancer survivor and believes it's a great pleasure to give back, wants economic fairness, protecting the rights of women and girls, and appreciated the opportunity to introduce herself.

Robert Davis, Ward 1, Lives on Sugar River Drive. Mr. Davis stated he served six years on the City Council. Mr. Davis also stated the condition of Sugar River Drive is atrocious, and noted

the gravel to fill potholes on tar roads just washes off after it rains. Mr. Davis stated people are trying to drive around to avoid pot holes. Mr. Davis wants to know why these pot holes aren't being filled and wants it addressed soon. Mayor Girard stated he will have the City Manager look into this, and will work with the Department of Public Works.

Walt Stapelton, Ward 3, New Hampshire House Representative stated roads are going to be a hot topic, and besides what was just heard from Mr. Davis; Mr. Stapelton wanted to bring Council's attention to Slab City Road. Mr. Stapelton noted how well the Elm Street paving was done and mentioned the DPW working very hard. Mr. Stapelton suggested that the City focuses on the worst roads.

Norman Blouin, Ward 3, stated the arm mower is a nice machine but the City needs a faster machine. Mr. Blouin mentioned concern over the process of purchasing a sewer truck, and stated the City is mismanaged.

Elizabeth Graham, Ward 1, made note of comments made by Councilors on Facebook were appalling and stated a couple of the Councilors are bullying citizens on Facebook.

OLD BUSINESS

Charter Amendment Vote

Motion to Issue Order to City Clerk for Placement of Proposed Charter Amendment on the Ballot for the September 13, 2022 Biennial Election by the State of New Hampshire

The Claremont City Council hereby submits a proposed amendment to the City Charter that seeks to alter Part I, Article III, Section 27 in order to remove the residency requirement for any potential hire for City Manager. The amendment also proposes to eliminate all pronouns provided within same. These Council-approved changes, associated with this Charter amendment, are provided below:

PROPOSED AMENDMENT TO CITY CHARTER:

Part I, Article III, Section 27 - Qualifications

Current Version

- **27. - Qualifications.**

The manager shall be chosen solely on the basis of his/her executive and administrative qualifications, but he/she need not be a resident of the city or state at the time of his/her appointment. During his/her tenure of office, he/she shall reside within the city. To avoid a conflict of interest, no person who has within two (2) years been elected by popular vote to any office in the City of Claremont shall be chosen manager.

Proposed Amendment to Section 27: The sentence “During his/her tenure of office, he/she shall reside within the city.” will be removed from the Charter. The pronouns will also be removed from this particular provision in the Charter.

- **27. - Qualifications.**

—The manager shall be chosen solely on the basis of his/her executive and administrative qualifications, but he/she need not be a resident of the city or state at the time of his/her appointment. ~~During his/her tenure of office, he/she shall reside within the city.~~ To avoid a conflict of interest, no person who has within two (2) years been elected by popular vote to any office in the City of Claremont shall be chosen manager.

New Version with Amendment:

- **27. - Qualifications.**

The manager shall be chosen solely on the basis of executive and administrative qualifications, but need not be a resident of the city or state at the time of appointment. To avoid a conflict of interest, no person who has within two (2) years been elected by popular vote to any office in the city of Claremont shall be chosen manager.

The Claremont City Council's approval of this Motion shall constitute the "order" in accordance with N.H. RSA §49-B:5. The Council hereby orders as well as authorizes the City Clerk to undertake any necessary actions or statutory obligations to effectuate the placement of this proposed amendment to the City's Charter on the ballot for the September 13, 2022 Biennial Election by the State of New Hampshire, including but not limited to, the creation of a "special municipal election" which shall be held simultaneously with the State's September 13, 2022 Election.

A motion was made by Councilor Belliveau and seconded by Councilor Stone to authorize the City Clerk to undertake any necessary actions or statutory obligations to effectuate the placement of this proposed amendment to the City's Charter

Roll call:

Contois - no

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau -yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-1

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Beliveau to remove the Transfer Station RFP discussion from the Table.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau -yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-1

Mayor Girard noted many emails have come in for the topic of the Transfer Station RFP and stated the emails have been 50/50 for and against. Mayor Girard then opened up comment from the public following the sign-up sheet.

Kevin Tyson, Ward 2, stated they have been a new resident of Claremont since February, Mr. Tyson explained noticing how inexpensive waste management was in town. Mr. Tyson agrees the RFP is a good deal and encourages the adoption of it.

Candice Crawford, Ward 2, thanked City Council for watching City expenses and trying to find ways to help save taxpayers money. Ms. Crawford stated it seems reasonable to raise ticket cost and is favor of keeping the transfer station open. Ms. Crawford also asked the Council to consider a committee devoted to the Transfer Station to make its decision.

Chiara Nelson, Ward 2, stated they have been contacting transfer stations in larger Cities like Lebanon, and smaller towns like Sunapee and explained these Transfer Stations are not charging as much for household waste, plastic, glass and paper than the RFP would. Ms. Nelson suggested that Council bring the RFP back to the table and find another deal that would work better for the City and the current users of the Transfer Station.

Walt Stapelton, Ward 3, stated being in favor of privatization for great efficiency, and noted DeCamp better fulfilled the RFP and has a proficient waste handling operation.

Peter Nelson, Ward 2, stated it saddens him that the Transfer Station is even a topic. Mr. Nelson stated that we need to be thinking about how the City Council works for the City/citizens rather than an individual business.

Clinton Lawrey, Ward 2, considers the Transfer Station as valuable for residents to recycle and have a cost-effective place to take trash. Mr. Lawrey stated the workers are always helpful. Mr. Lawrey noted the cost of transfer station has been an issue for many years, and wants to table the entire privatization, and let the increased fees go on for a year and then see the financials before making a decision.

Patrick Lozito, Ward 1, stated the Transfer station is not being closed and the Transfer Station is already using a private company [Casella] to take haul trash. Mr. Lozito stated privatizing the Transfer Station through DeCamp would benefit the tax-payers, and would be able to use the two City Staff members in other areas of the City.

Aaron Dabanavich, Ward 1, stated the Council should pull back and look at the broad trend of privatization and that its not a good solution, privatization exists to generate profit for themselves. Mr. Dabanavich stated public services should remain public.

Elizabeth Bowser, Ward 1, agrees with those against privatization, Ms. Bowser stated public services should be provided by the town. Ms. Bowser stated privatization increases exploitation, and asked if the Transfer Station has a \$100,000.00 deficit, why would DeCamp want it.

Ernest Montenegro, Ward 1, stated this is still a democracy and encourages the Council to create an open forum for this topic so everyone has a voice. Mr. Montenegro stated every citizen has a right to critic what the Council or Government is doing.

Mark Chamberlin, Ward 1, agreed with Dabanavich.

Norm Blouin, Ward 3, compared the Transfer Station with the Community Center. Mr. Blouin does not agree with closing down the Transfer Station.

Donna Montenegro, Ward 1, Wants to thank Mayor Girard for responding to her email. Ms. Montenegro agrees with Elizabeth Graham; that Councilors who are bullying citizens on Facebook is very wrong and thinks they shouldn't be Councilors if they can't respect citizens. Ms. Montenegro agrees with Ms. Crawford to create a committee to make decisions relative to the Transfer Station.

Becca Mackenzie, Ward 2, read a letter that was sent to Council by Charlene Lovett:

"It is my understanding that tonight's Council meeting includes an agenda item on the Transfer Station. I will not be able to attend the meeting tonight as I will be out of town, but I wanted to offer a funding resource for your consideration.

The recently passed Bipartisan Infrastructure Law provides \$375 million in funding for the EPA to develop three new waste prevention, reuse and recycling programs. One of these programs is the Solid Waste Infrastructure and Recycling Grant Program. The program offers municipalities the opportunity to improve infrastructure and make improvements to local waste management systems. Grant applications will be available in September or October of 2022 with funding available in the spring of 2023. Matching funds from municipalities are not required.

If the objective of the Council is to eliminate the need for taxpayers to subsidize the Transfer Station, this grant opportunity could provide the funding necessary to implement the changes needed to make the operation cost neutral. It would also allow the Council to maintain a community asset that promotes recycling and supports the statewide priority of waste reduction. "

Mayor Girard called a 5-minute break.

Meeting called back to order at 7:42 PM

Zadia Eisenberg, Ward 1, asked why the DPW did not have a chance to give an option for the RFP. Ms. Eisenberg stated not being opposed to the idea of privatization but is opposed to only having one option, and asked the Council to “slow down”.

Mike Demars, Ward 3, stated the support of the proposal, and stated the privatization does make sense. Mr. Demars shared the Transfer Station isn't closing, and agreed that the workers at the Transfer Station should be going back the City to help work on roads.

Sam Killay, Ward 3, stated he does not believe DeCamp can guarantee they will not increase their prices. Mr. Killay noted raising costs for citizens only disincentivizes people to get rid of their waste responsibly, and noted this will affect property taxes so the privatization is not beneficial in the long run.

Steve Wood, Ward 3, encouraged the Council to consider other options and alternatives.

Bob Davis, Ward 1, opposed to the privatization of the transfer station. Mr. Davis stated once its released it will be out of City control. This service; is a service for the citizens of Claremont, like Fire, Police, and DPW. Mr. Davis stated if the Transfer Station holds so much controversy it should go onto the Ballot.

John Cloutier, Ward 3, State representative for Claremont has been a user since the Transfer Station started. Mr. Cloutier stated the staff has been helpful, and even jumpstarted his car. Mr. Cloutier noted good people work there, and shared concern for privatization and the need to encourage recycling.

Mike Tetu, Ward 1, encouraged the Council not to enter into privatization and shared signatures from 680 people who would be against privatization and closure of the Transfer Station.

Mayor Girard thanked everyone for the opportunity to hear everyone's thoughts on this topic.

Councilor Contois stated a point has been made by many people that the cost is insignificant. Councilor Contois noted Mr. Tetu has 680 signatures and that is a lot more people than the Council was led to believe are using the Transfer Station.

Councilor Koloski questioned the number of signatures on the petition and made note there are current contracts with other providers for services such as paving, mowing and the ambulance service in the community.

Assistant Mayor Matteau reiterated the Council is not closing Transfer Station, and shared if going with DeCamp there will be a very carefully written contract with an out clause.

Councilor Mooshian thanked everyone for coming out, and understands concerns for both sides.

Councilor Koloski stated if the Council authorizes the City Manager there are several questions he wants answered: Free tire day- is this a service DeCamp will provide or billed to the City? Who collects the downtown trash cans? Is DeCamp providing trash services to City Hall, Fire, and Planning and Development if not, which budget will this come out of?

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked if the vote was to move forward will the contract come back to council.

Mr. Bohenko stated once the contract is negotiated and in its final form it can be sent to Council for review.

Transfer Station RFP

At the direction of the City Council an RFP was advertised to explore the cost effectiveness of privatizing the Transfer Station. On June 13th there was a public bid opening with two interested companies for review; DeCamp Waste Services and Casella Waste Management, Inc (Casella).

Both options would reduce the cost of the tax rate for the operation less the cost of vegetation control and land fill monitoring which averages around \$18,000 per year. The table below reflects highlights from the RFP proposals and if there were requirements not met.

Company	Met the Bid Spec	Rate Sheet Prices	Other
DeCamp W.S.	YES	Most Favorable (See Attached)	
Casella	NO <i>Proposal Exemption indicates "Casella will NOT be responsible for paying any City tax, including property tax**" 4 (pg:6)</i>	Least Favorable (See Attached)	
Casella (Alternative	NO (The RFP was for operation in its		Alternate Proposal includes a payment to the city for \$24,000

<i>Proposal)</i>	<i>current footprint. This option is for closure of the station.)</i>	See Casella RFP “Alternate Proposal” (pg:6)	annually as a “host community fee”
------------------	---	---	---------------------------------------

***RSA 73:23-b (b) All leases and other agreements, the terms of which provide for the use or occupation by others of real or personal property owned by the state or a city, town, school district, or village district, entered into after July 1, 1979, shall provide for the payment of properly assessed real and personal property taxes by the party using or occupying said property no later than the due date*

Attached with this memo are both RFPs for review and an attachment that shows the estimated cost comparisons that residents would potentially be charged based on current rates through the RFP process.

Staff Recommendation:

If it is the decision of the council to continue moving forward with privatizing the Transfer Station, then it is the staff’s recommendation in accordance with the most responsible proposal, RFP requirements, and staff review that the City Council authorize the City Manager to enter into negotiations with DeCamp Waste Services.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Limoges to move that the City Manager be authorized to negotiate with DeCamp for the privatization of the City of Claremont Transfer Station.

Roll call:

Contois -no

O’Hearne -no

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - yes

Motion carried 5-4

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2023-6 NHCF Award for Fiske Free Library

RESOLUTION 2023-6

New Hampshire Charitable Foundation Grant

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has been awarded a New Hampshire Charitable Foundation Grant in the amount of \$10,000.00 to renovate the Children's area and update the adult reading area at the Fiske Free Library; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the New Hampshire Charitable Foundation Grant for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept a grant in the amount of \$10,000.00 from the New Hampshire Charitable Foundation for the purpose for renovating the children's area and update the adult reading area; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the sum of \$10,000.00 for the Fiske Free Library to come from the New Hampshire Charitable Foundation Grant (to have no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Mr. Grace explained the grant to Council. Councilor Contois commended the library for getting this money.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to adopt Resolution 2023-6.

Councilor Contois read resolution 2023-6 into record

Mayor opened up for public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Contois -yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

Invest NH Housing Grant

InvestNH program, designed to accelerate additional units of affordable rental housing. \$60 million will be available for the Capital Grant Program and \$40 million will be available for the Municipal Program. The rules released this week are specific to the Capital Grant Program.

Rules for the Municipal Programs will be available later this month with the goal of launching three municipal programs; unit incentive program, demolition program, and planning and zoning program. We request that the City Council authorize the City Manager to apply for appropriate funds as they become available, to include expenses for the demolition of two city owned properties on Main Street.

Ms. Merrill explained the Invest NH program was created out of the Governor's office with recovery funds. 60M will go to new housing units and applications will be coming out next week. The municipal rules have not been released yet. Ms. Merrill stated this money could be helpful for the two Main Street demolition projects.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Beliveau to authorize the City Manager or his designees to apply for municipal funds through the Invest NH housing program.

Voice vote:
Contois - yes
O'Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

CDBG-CV or CDBG Public Facility Grant Application

Community Development Block Grant Project

Community Development Block Grant funds are available to municipalities through the NH Community Development Finance Authority. Up to \$500,000 annually is available for Economic Development Projects, up

\$500,000 for Housing Projects, up to \$500,000 for Public Facility Projects, up to \$500,000 in Emergency Funds, up to \$25,000 per Planning Study grant. Also, up to \$750,000 is available per public facility project under CDBG-Covid (CDBG-CV) funding. All projects must directly benefit a majority of low- and moderate-income persons.

Public Hearing on the Proposed Claremont Learning Partnership Improvements Project CDBG Application

A proposed application to the NH Community Development Finance Authority for up to \$750,000 in CDBG-CV, or up to \$500,000 in CDBG Public Facilities funds towards improvements at the Claremont Learning Partnership building at 169 Main Street. Improvements to include new roof with insulation barrier, installation of fresh air HVAC systems, weather tight doors, replace all windows with broken seals, enhance the security around the perimeter of the building, add solar panels to the roof, and replace missing asphalt in the parking lot on the Elm Street side of the building. The majority of the people served at the Claremont Learning Partnership are of low or moderate income.

This project conforms with Claremont's Housing and Community Development Plan's goal of: Plan for complementary services such as affordable daycare that allow families to participate in the workforce. Encourage other services that will benefit low- and moderate income persons... (Short-term and long-term goal).

Public Hearing on the Residential Antidisplacement and Relocation Assistance Plan for the proposed Claremont Learning Partnership Project

This plan outlines measures, under the Uniform Relocation Act, required for CDBG projects that involve any displacement or relocation of persons (or businesses). If the City were to undertake a CDBG project which involved displacement or relocation they would follow this plan. The plan outlines the measures they would take to find comparable, suitable housing for persons (or businesses) displaced or relocated. No displacement or relocation is anticipated with this project.

Public Hearing on the Proposed Claremont Housing Authority's Improvements Project CDBG Application

A proposed application to the NH Community Development Finance Authority for up to \$500,000 in CDBG Housing Funds towards improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority's property, the Marion Phillips Apartments, at 243 Broad Street, Claremont. Improvements to include Boiler System Replacement. All of the 96 apartments are occupied by elderly and disabled persons of extremely low and low income.

This project conforms with Claremont's Housing and Community Development Plan's goal of: Recognize the need for clean, decent and affordable housing for households at all income levels. (Long- and short-term goal)

Public Hearing on the Residential Antidisplacement and Relocation Assistance Plan for the proposed Claremont Learning Partnership Project

This plan outlines measures, under the Uniform Relocation Act, required for CDBG projects that involve any displacement or relocation of persons (or businesses), if the City were to undertake a CDBG project which involved displacement or relocation they would follow this plan. The plan outlines the measures they would take to find comparable, suitable housing for persons (or businesses) displaced or relocated. No displacement or relocation is anticipated with this project.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing

Norm Blouin, Ward 3, shared his concern for low-income people coming to town. Mr. Blouin stated the City doesn't need more low income grants, and there is a lot of low-income buildings with no-one living in them.

Mayor Girard closed the public hearing

Motion to Submit CDBG Application for Claremont Learning Partnership

The Claremont City Council hereby approves the submission of a Community Development Block Grant application for up to \$750,000 in CDBG-CV funds, or up to \$500,000 in CDBG Public Facilities funds (consistent with public hearing notice), toward improvements at the Claremont Learning Partnership building at 169 Main Street, and to further authorize the City Manager to sign and submit the application, and upon approval of the CDBG Public Facilities or CDBG-CV application, authorize the City Manager to execute any documents which may be necessary to effectuate the CDBG Public Facilities/CDBG-CV contract and any other amendments thereto.

A motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to authorize the City Manager to sign and submit the application, and upon approval of the CDBG Public Facilities or CDBG-CV application, and upon approval of the CDBG Public Facilities or CDBG-CV application, authorize the City Manager to execute any documents which may be necessary to effectuate the CDBG Public Facilities/CDBG-CV contract and any other amendments thereto.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

Motion to Adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan – Claremont Leaming Partnership. 169 Main Street

The Claremont City Council hereby moves to adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan for the proposed CDBG Public Facilities or CV project funds to be used for improvements at the Claremont Leaming Partnership building at 169 Main Street.

Mayor Girard opened public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan

Roll call:
Contois - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

Motion to Submit CDBG Application for Claremont Housing Authority

The Claremont City Council hereby approves the submission of a Community Development Block Grant application for up to \$500,000 in CDBG Housing funds (consistent with public hearing notice), toward improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority Property (Marion Phillips Apartments) at 243 Broad Street, and to further authorize the City Manager to sign and submit the application, and upon approval of the CDBG Housing application, authorize the City Manager to execute any documents which may be necessary to effectuate the CDBG Housing contract and any other amendments thereto.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to authorize the City Manager to sign and submit the application, and upon approval of the CDBG Housing application, authorize the City Manager to execute any documents which may be necessary to effectuate the CDBG Housing contract and any other amendments thereto.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Motion to Adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan – Claremont Housing Authority, 243 Broad Street

The Claremont City Council hereby moves to adopt the City's Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan for the proposed CDBG Housing funds to be used for improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority's Marion Phillips Apartments at 243 Broad Street.

Mayor Girard opened up a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

A motion was made by Councilor Beliveau and seconded by O’Hearne to adopt the City’s Residential Anti-Displacement and Relocation Assistance Plan for the proposed CDBG Housing funds to be used for improvements at the Claremont Housing Authority’s Marion Phillips Apartments at 243 Broad Street.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2023-7 OHRV Grant NH Fish and Game & Claremont Police Partnership – Public Hearing (City Manager/Police Chief)

RESOLUTION 2023-7

OHRV Enforcement Grant

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has been awarded a New Hampshire Fish and Game Off Highway Recreational Vehicle (OHRV) Enforcement Grant in the amount of \$1,800.00 for OHRV enforcement patrols by the Claremont Police Department; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the OHRV Enforcement grant funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept a grant in the amount of \$1,800.00 from the State of New Hampshire Fish and Game Department for the purpose of OHRV enforcement by the Claremont Police Department; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the sum of \$1,800.00 for the Police Department (from off-setting grant revenue) for the purpose of providing additional OHRV enforcement patrols by the Claremont Police Department with no impact on the tax rate; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Chief Chase stated this was a yearly exercise, and stated there is a strong relationship with NH Fish and Game who patrol our OHRV trails. Chief Chase did note last year the grant was larger and is asking Council for acceptance to provide the 40 hours for patrol.

Mayor Girard opened up a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Stone to adopt Resolution 2023-7.

Roll call:

Contois -yes

O'Hearne -yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Contois mentioned an up-coming litter prevention campaign, and noted the Conservation Commission and the Ford Motor Company relative to wetlands had a hearing today.

Assistant Mayor Matteau made note the Planning Board had a couple who is starting a ministry in their home, Barn Café is putting in additional parking with 4 Charging stations.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Mooshian reminded the Council on some comments made by Citizens tonight and asked if the Council could look into establishing an Ethics Committee that can independently evaluate some of these allegations against Councilors and then make non-binding recommendations on how to proceed.

Councilor Koloski asked to review the financials at the Community Center, wants to address issues like the pool closing.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:13 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Beliveau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote :

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council